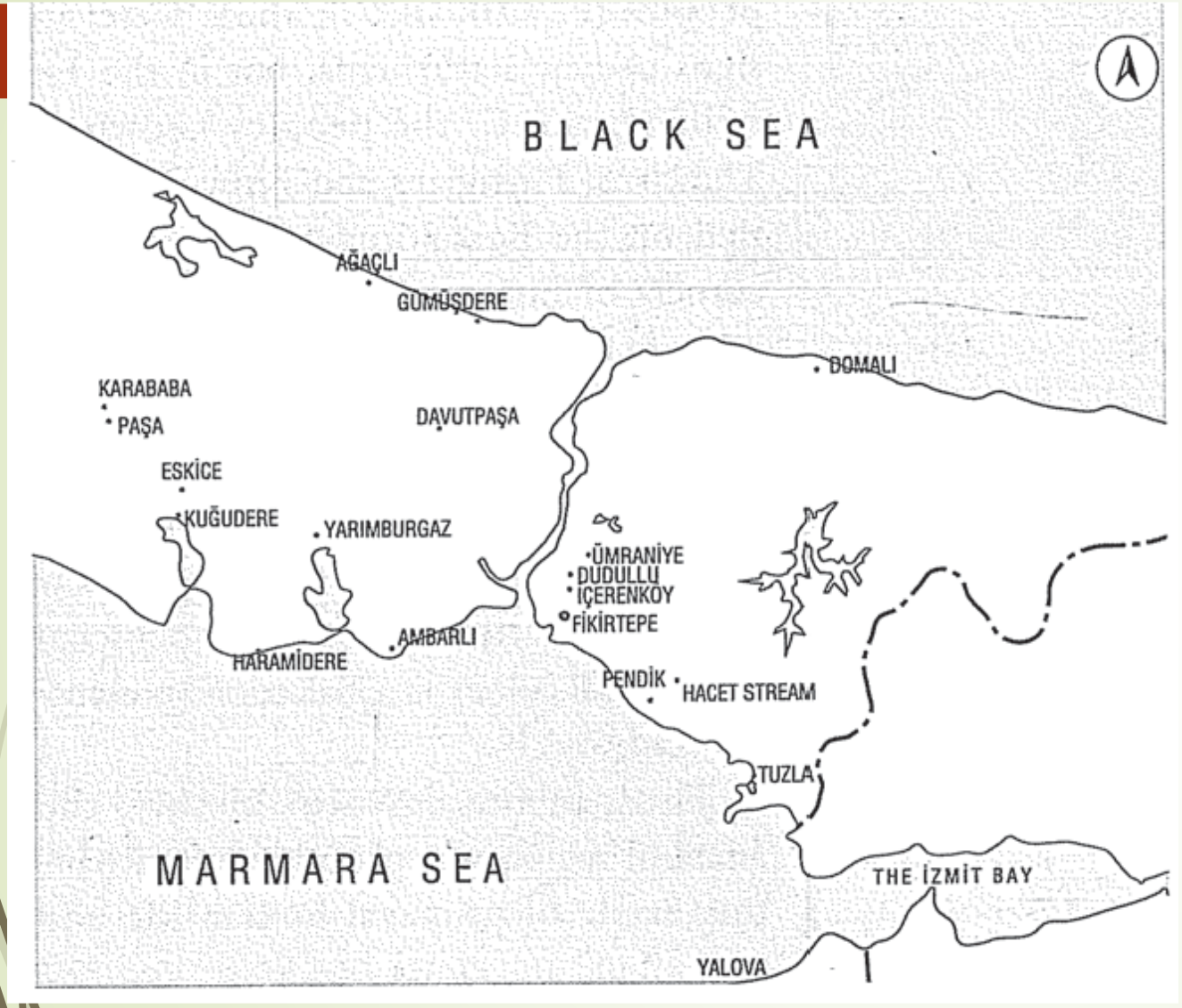


History and Cultural Heritage of Istanbul

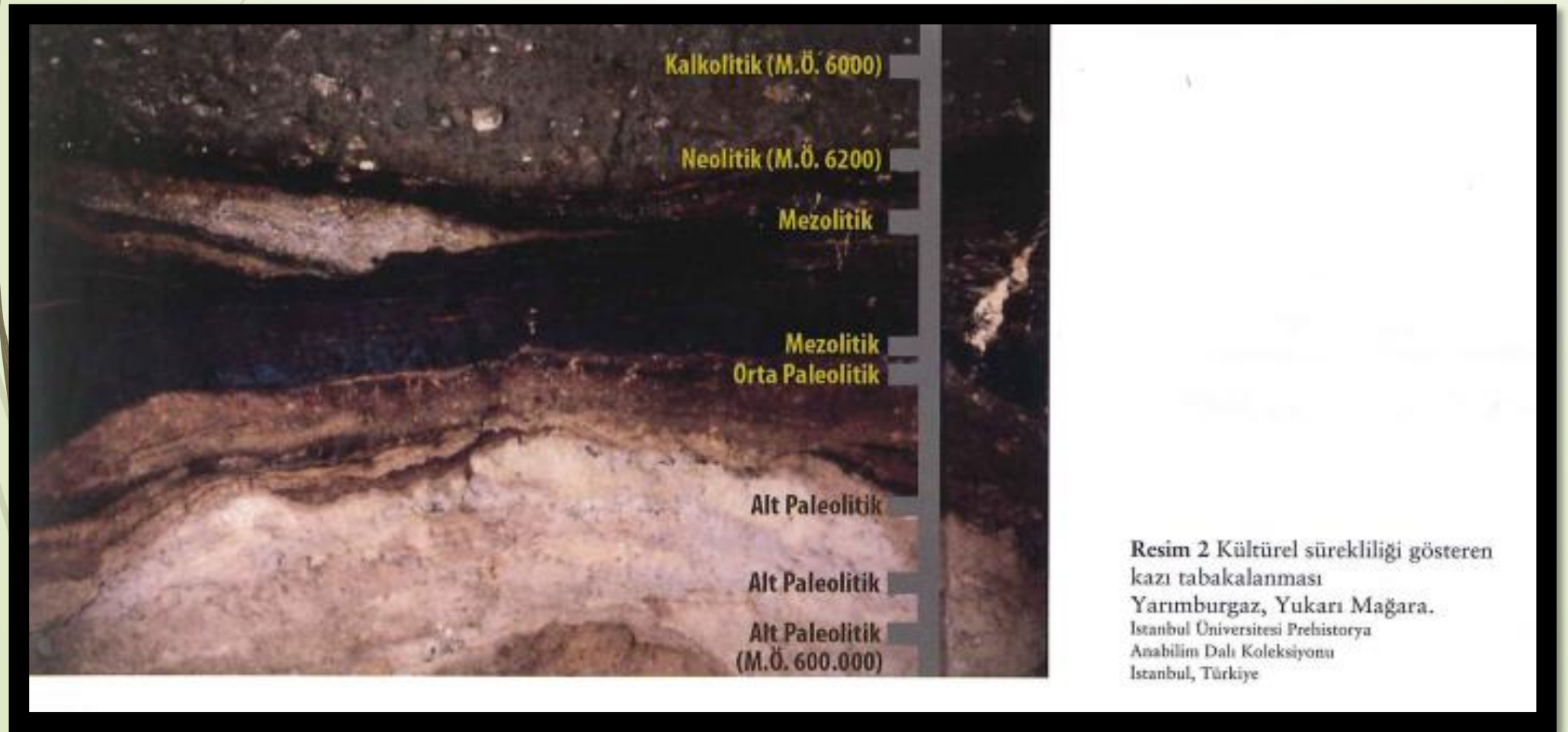
Week 2



Prehistoric Settlements in Istanbul and Its Surroundings

PALEOLITHIC AGE (1 million-10,000 years ago)

- **YARIMBURGAZ CAVE** near Küçük Çekmece Lake
- Tools used by people who make a living from fishing and hunting



Resim 2 Kültürel sürekliliği gösteren kazı tabakalanması
Yarımburgaz, Yukarı Mağara.
İstanbul Üniversitesi Prehistorya Anabilim Dalı Koleksiyonu
İstanbul, Türkiye

NEOLITHIC AGE (6,600-5,800 BC)

- Marmara was a narrower lake during this period. The first Neolithic settlements near the shore were established near the streams flowing into this lake and over time they were submerged under the Sea of Marmara.

- **Yenikapı, FİKİRTEPE**, İçerenköy, Pendik-Kaynarca, Tuzla-İçmeler

- The Neolithic Age communities of Istanbul are called the «**Fikirtepe Culture**».
- Partly agriculture, animal husbandry, hunting, fishing
- Pottery, tools



Resim 4 Neolitik döneme ait Fikirtepe kültüründe kemik-kaşık olarak adlandırılan aletler Fikirtepe-Pendik

CHALCOLITHIC AGE (5,800-3,200 BC)

- Cultures of Yenikapı and Yarımburgaz Cave dating to this period.
- Our information about this period is limited.



BRONZE AGE (3200-1100 BC)

- Limited information
- Ayamama Creek in Ataköy, Moda Bay

EARLY IRON AGE (1100-900 BC)

- Ataköy Ayamama Creek, Yenikapı
- During this period, a wave of migration from the Northern Balkans spread from Istanbul to Thrace.



Figure 11 a-d: İnsan Yüzü Betimli Çömlek, Hipodrom, Geç Kalkolitik Çağ, Pişmiş Toprak / *Jug with the Human Face Decoration, Hippodrome, Late Chalcolithic Period, Terracotta*



Figure 19 ab: Testi, Fenerbahçe Yat Limanı, Erken Tunç Çağı II-III, Pişmiş Toprak / *Pitcher, Fenerbahçe Yacht Harbour, Early Bronze Age II-III, Terracotta*

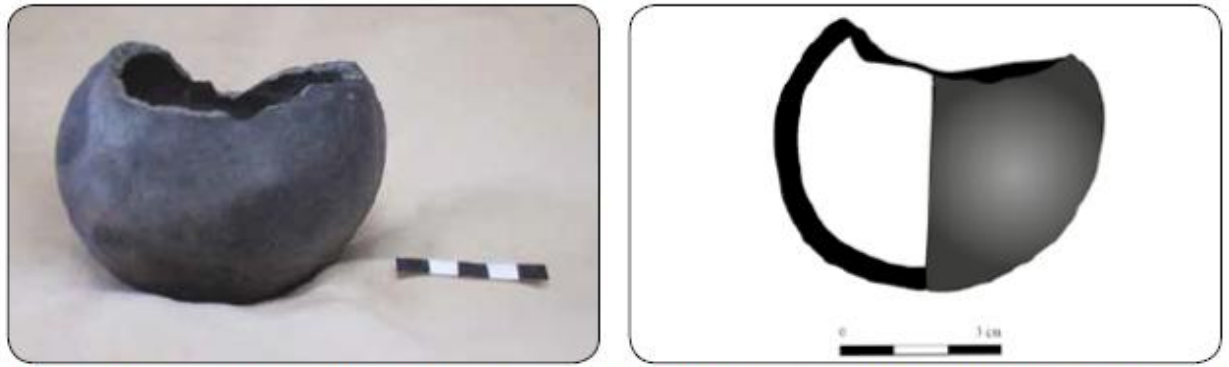
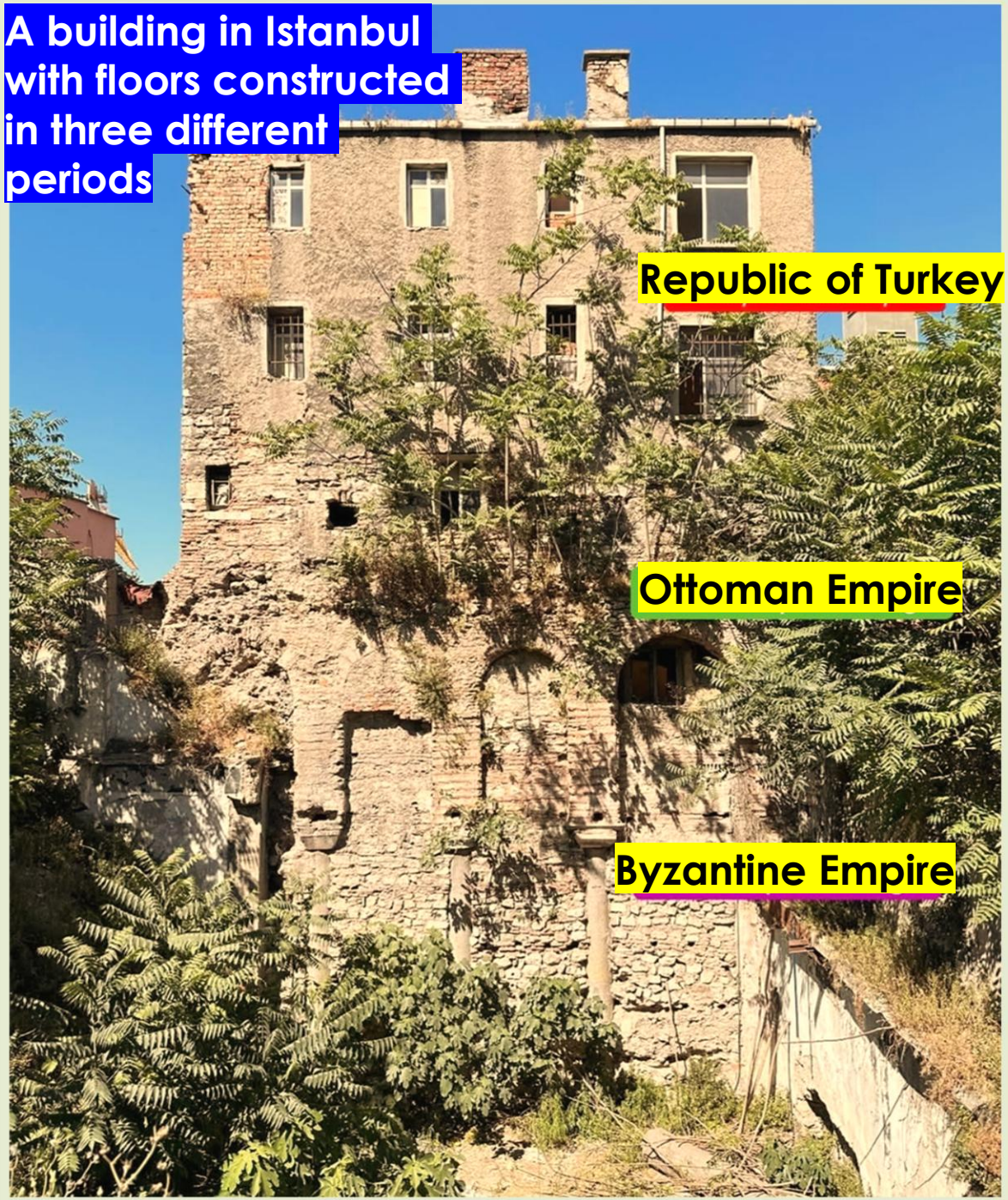


Figure 20 ab: Testi, Fenerbahçe Yat Limanı, Erken Tunç Çağı II-III, Pişmiş Toprak / *Pitcher, Fenerbahçe Yacht Harbour, Early Bronze Age II-III, Terracotta*



CITY HISTORY OF ISTANBUL

From now on, we will name the city according to the name used in that period.

- **Byzantion/Byzantium*:BC. 667?-AD. 330**

  ***Original Ancient Greek form:** Βυζάντιον (Byzantion).*
  ***The form common in Latin and English:** Byzantium.*

- **Constantinople: 330-1453**
- **İstanbul/Ottoman's Istanbul: 1453-1923**
- **İstanbul: 1923-**

PERIODS OF DOMINATION IN ISTANBUL

- B.C.: 695?-667?-660?: Megarans
- The sieges and short-term dominance of the Dorians, Ionians, Persians (Darius I-5th century BC) and Spartans
- BC. 146: Roman as dependent city status
- 196: Septimus Severus' destruction of Byzantion
- 330-395: Roman Empire
- 395-1204 ve1261-1453: Eastern Roman (Byzantine) Empire
- Latin Empire: 1204-1261
- Ottoman Empire: 1453-1923

Istanbul's old city settlement

- The present-day city of Istanbul included three ancient towns, **Byzantion/Byzantium, Kalkhedon (Kadıköy) and Selymbria (Silivri).**
- Located on both sides of the Bosphorus, Byzantium and Kalkhedon are the settlements that form the core of today's Istanbul. Selymbria was outside the city, within the borders of the Silivri district.



The Legend of the City's Foundation

- The widespread legend about **the city's first foundation is that it was founded as a Megarian colony.**
- According to the legend, the name of the commander at the head of the Megarians was Byzas, and the name of the city came from there.

- The founding of Byzantium by Byzas is recounted as a legend, which exists in a few different versions. Ancient sources and legends supply the following information concerning the identity of Byzas:

(a) he was a Thracian king who was the son of a local nymph(water fairy) named Semestra;
(b) he was the son of Poseidon and Keroessa, the daughter of Io;
(c) he was the leader of the Megarians.



The City's Most Famous Founding Legend

- According to the tradition based on legends, Byzantium was founded by colonists from the city of Megara in Central Greece. However, it is likely that the Megarians were also joined by people from other places, especially from Kalkhedon and Miletos.
- According to one view, the founder was Byzas, the leader of the Megarians; the city's name is derived from Byzas.
- On the obverse of the Roman Imperial coins of Byzantion appears the helmeted and bearded bust of Byzas along with his name. On the reverse, the ship depicted is, according to one view, the vessel that brought Byzas from Megara to Byzantion.



The Legend..

According to the second legend, Io, the daughter of the Argive king Inachus, was the priestess of the Temple of Hera in the city of Argos. One day, the god Zeus saw Io and fell in love with her. On learning that her husband Zeus was enamored of another woman, Hera became consumed with jealousy, and sought ways to separate Io from Zeus. In order to protect Io from Hera's wrath, Zeus turned her into a cow. However, Hera asked that the cow be given to her; she took Io, and set the thousand-eyed giant Argos to guard her. Zeus then sent Hermes, the messenger god, who put Argos into a trance, and then killed him. Io was freed from the giant; however, this time Hera sent a horsefly to harass her. Whenever the fly bit her, Io – in the guise of a cow – felt great discomfort; she came from Thrace to the Bosphorus, and crossed to the Asian side, arriving at what is now the neighborhood of Eyüp at the end of the Golden Horn. Aft er crossing the Golden Horn (Chrysokeras), Iogave birth to a daughter, whom she named Keroessa. Keroessa had a child, Byzas, with the sea-god Poseidon. Byzas was brought up by a nymph named Byzia; when he became a young man, he went on to found the city of Byzantium.

Because of the story of Io crossing the Bosphorus in the form of a cow, the Bosphorus acquired its name (Bosporos literally means "Cow Crossing"). This anecdote was well-known in antiquity. Though it would appear, according to this legend, that the place where Byzas and the colonists decided to found the city of Byzanti um was at the site of present-day Sivritepe on the shore of the Golden Horn (the location of the Altar of Semystra), the legend nonetheless indicates Sarayburnu (now occupied by Topkapı Palace) as the place where the city was founded. Dionysius of Halicarnassus has recounted, upon deciding to found the city, the colonists sacrificed an animal; as they were cooking it, a crow snatched a piece of its meat from the flames and flew away with it into the sky. However, guided by a shepherd – who watched where the crow went from a high hill – they discovered that the crow had taken the piece of sacrificial meat to the Bosphorus Cape. The colonists regarded this as a divine portent, and founded the city on the cape (today's Sarayburnu). On the obverse of Byzantium's coins minted under the Roman Empire, there is a helmeted, bearded bust of Byzas, along with an inscription indicating his name in Greek (ΒΥΖΑΣ).

Date of Establishment?

- **We do not have any clear information about the city's founding date.**
- Herodotus (5th century BC) says that Byzantium was founded 17 years after Kalkhedon. Eusebius, who lived much later than Herodotus during the Roman Imperial Period, gives the founding date of Kalkhedon as 685 BC and Byzantion as 660/659 BC.
- Both the historian Herodotus and the geographer Strabon from Amaseia (Amasya), who lived in the 1st century BC-1st century AD, state that the first settlement on the Bosphorus was in Kalkhedon on the Anatolian side can be explained by the fact that the Kalkhedonians were blind: *If they were not blind, they would not have come and settled here when there was such a convenient place on the opposite shore.*
- As a result, **it can be said that Byzantium was founded in the middle of the 7th century BC (695?-667?-660?) and after Kalkhedon (Kadıköy).**

KHALKHEDON/HALKEDON

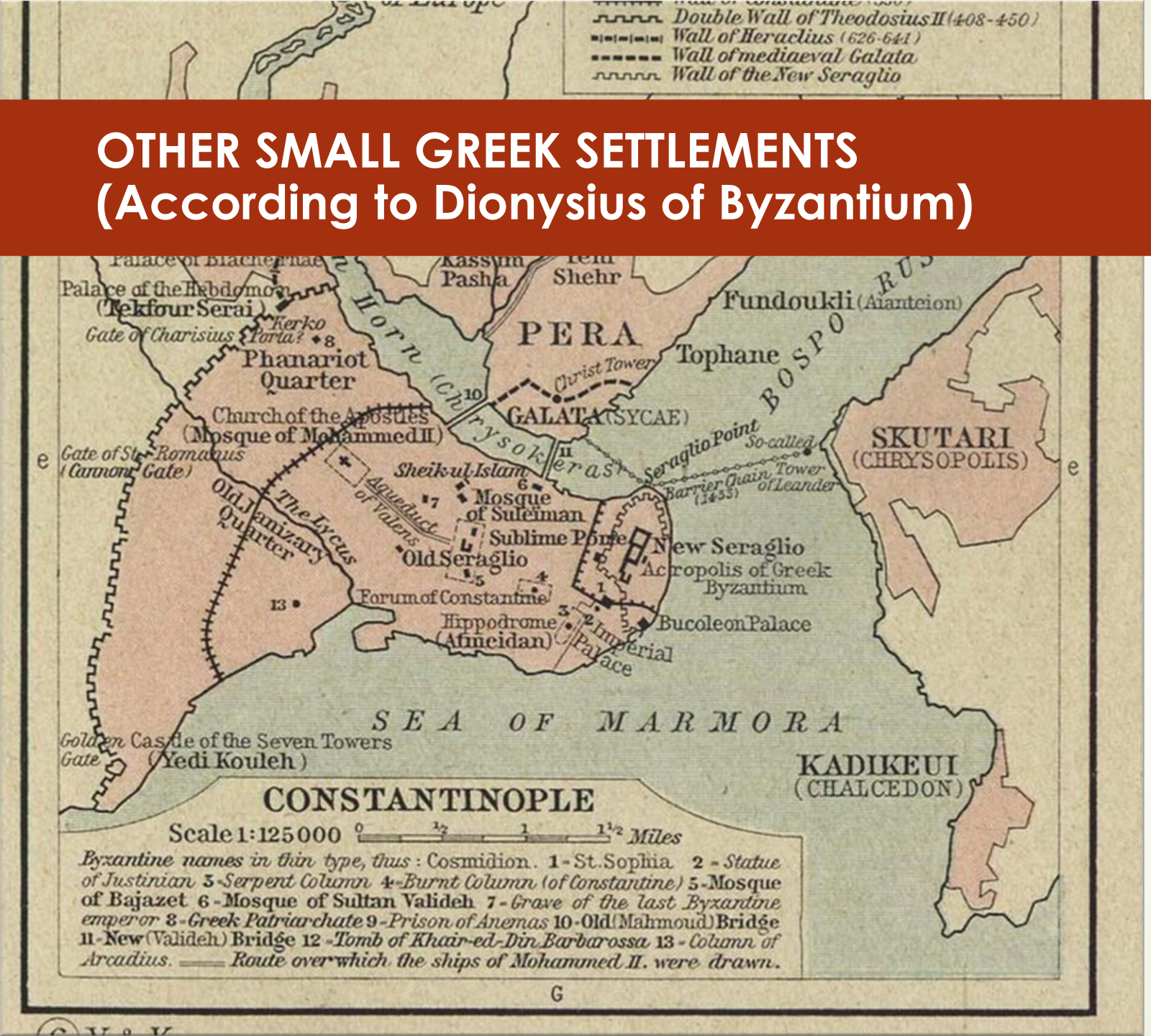
- According to legend, the Megarians, who came from the city of Megara, a neighbor of Athens and Sparta on the Greek peninsula, first founded a city in Khalkedon (Kadıköy) near modern-day Moda, under the leadership of Byzas.
- The fact that Kalkhedon was referred to as the "land of the blind" was a well-known story in Antiquity.



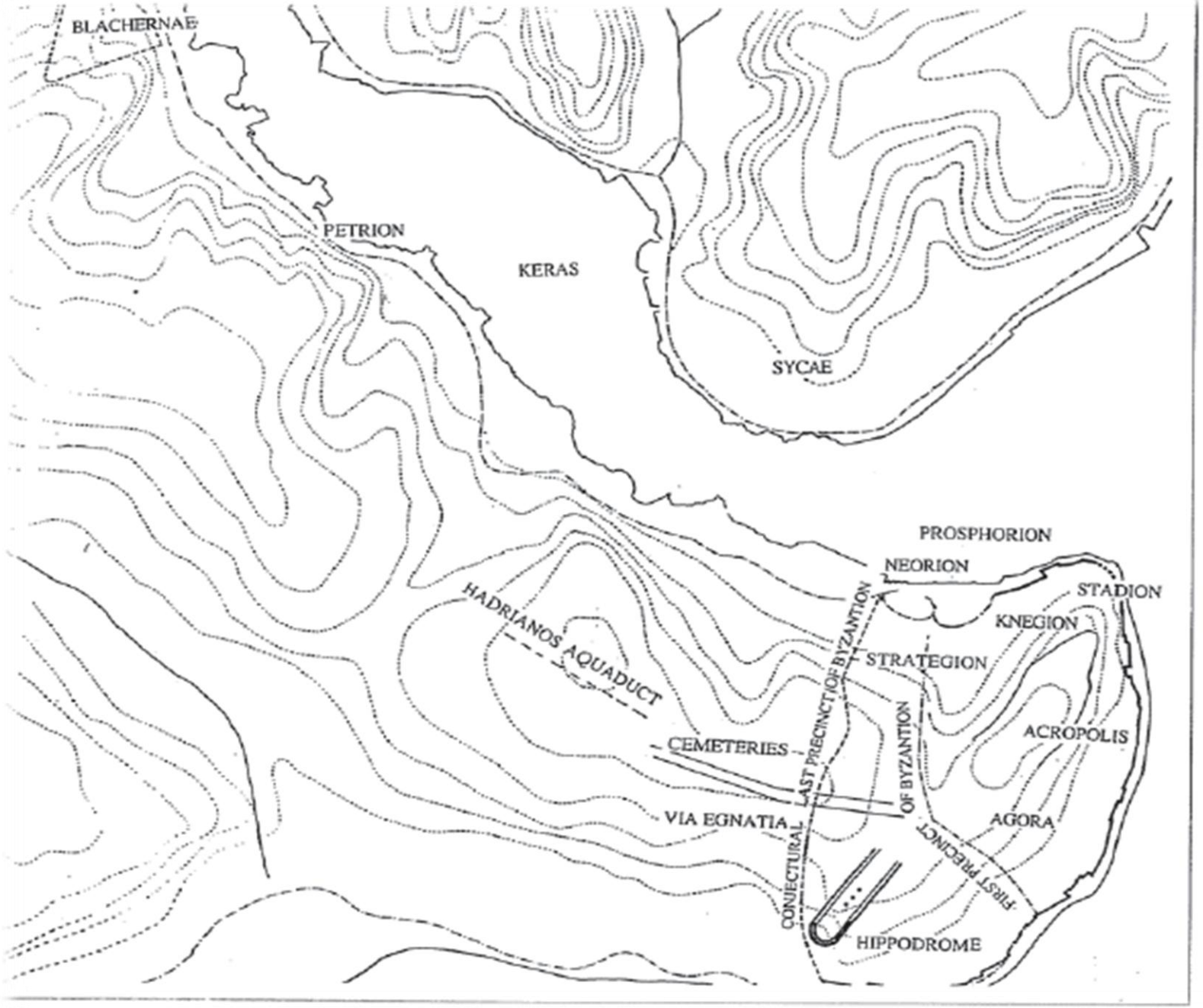
Land of the blind

(According to legend) When the Megarians consulted the Oracle of Delphi, they learned that the country they were looking for was opposite the Land of the Blind (Sarayburnu opposite Kadıköy). The immigrants who came to Sarayburnu did not see the beauty of the European continent and stated that the Chalcedonians who founded the city in Kadıköy in Anatolia were blind, and called Kadıköy the Land of the Blind.

OTHER SMALL GREEK SETTLEMENTS (According to Dionysius of Byzantium)



- Sykai (Galata)
- Hrispolis/Khrysopolis – Scutarion (Üsküdar) (a shipyard under the Persian administration)
- Kidaros (Alibeyköy)
- Barbisos (Kağıthane)
- Selmybria (Silivri)



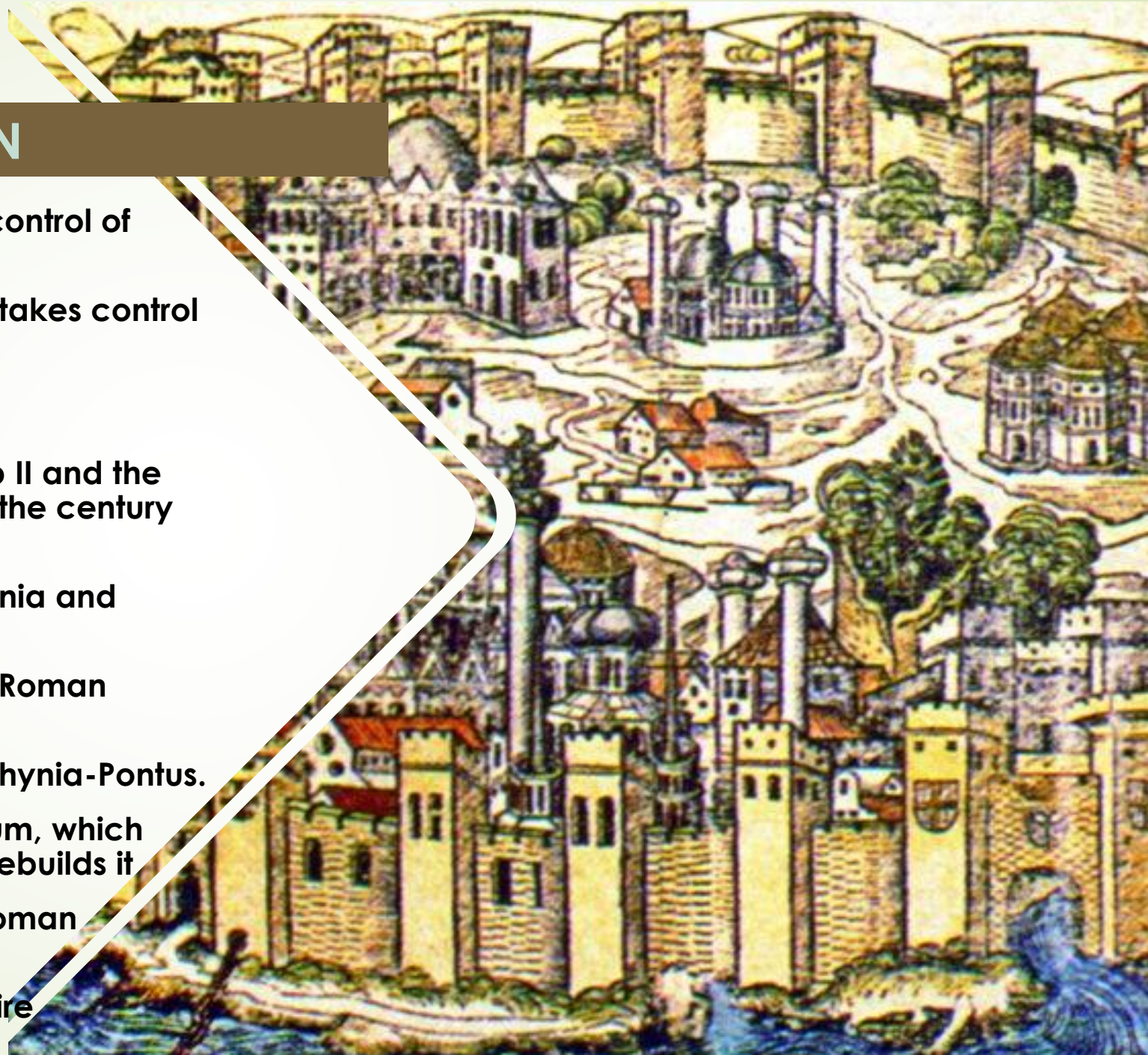
6. Byzantion, the first and the last precincts, (conjectural)

In this period, Byzantium also had the character of a colonial settlement.

Byzantium

Brief Chronology of BYZANTION

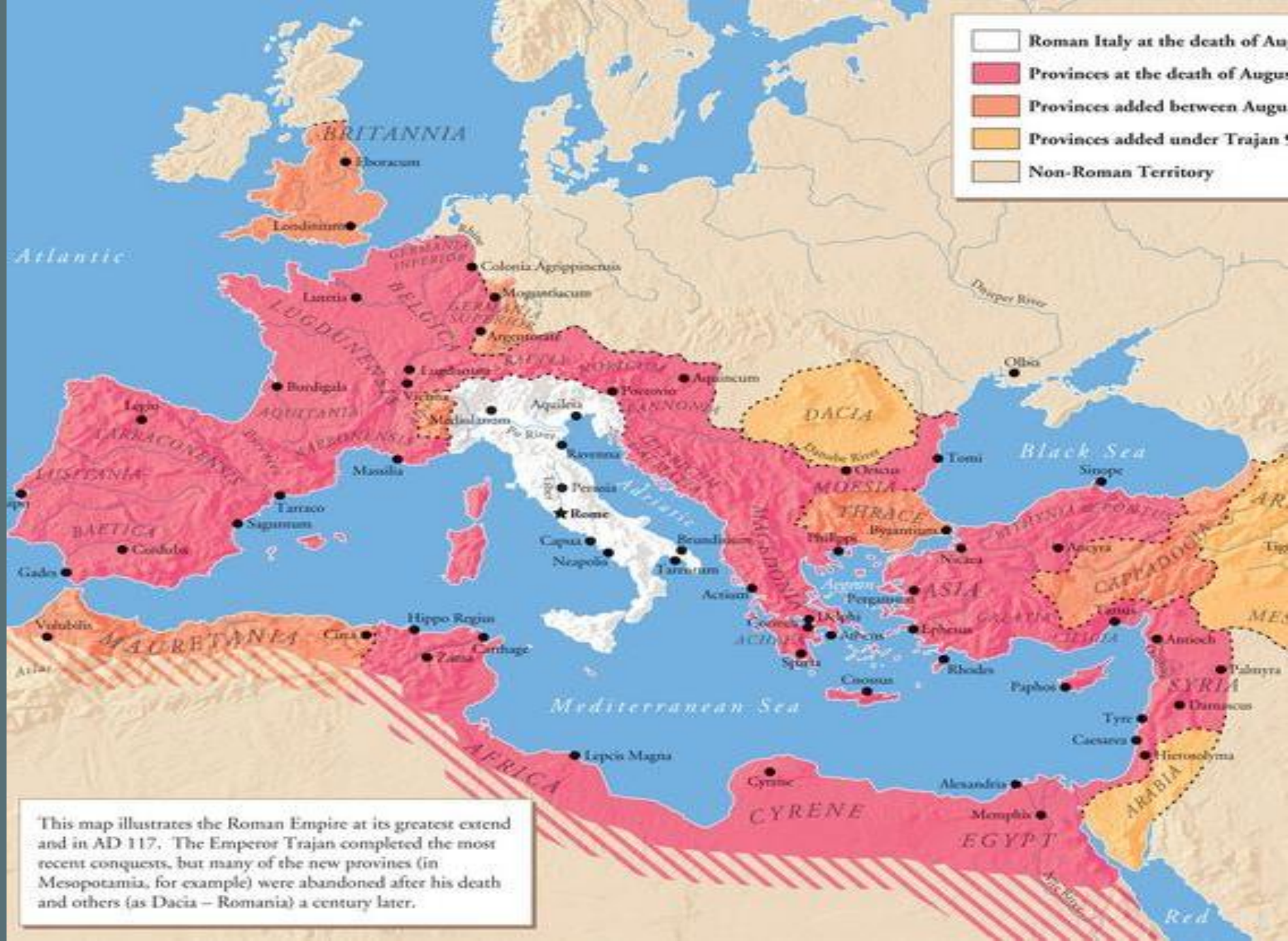
- 513 BC: Persian ruler Darius the Great takes control of Byzantium and Chalcedon
- 479-477 BC: Spartan commander Pausanias takes control
- Athenian rule until 411 BC
- 405-340/339 BC: Spartan rule
- 340/339 BC: Siege of Macedonian King Philip II and the Hellenistic period that lasted until the end of the century
- 3rd century BC: Dependent on the Galatian Confederation (tax) - pressure from the Bithynia and Macedonian kingdoms
- 2nd century BC: City-state affiliated with the Roman Republic after the Roman-Macedonian war
- 73 AD: Included in the Roman Province of Bithynia-Pontus.
- 193-196: Septimus Severus besieges Byzantium, which does not support him, destroys the city and rebuilds it
- 324: Byzantium is completely captured by Roman Emperor Constantine I
- 330: Becomes the capital of the Roman Empire



Political History of Byzantium (From Its Foundation to 324 AD)

- Byzantium was subject to attacks from the Thracian tribes from the moment it was founded.
- During his campaign against the Scythians (late 6th century BC), the Persian king Darius passed from Anatolia to Thrace through the Bosphorus; both Byzantion and Calkhedon came under Persian control.
- During the Ionian Revolt that started in 500 BC, the Ionians captured Sardes and then Byzantion and other cities in the region. After the suppression of the Ionian Revolt, Byzantion and the towns in the region were burned and destroyed by the Phoenician fleet, which was an ally of the Persians.
- The Persian holded the city for a while. After the Persians were defeated by the Athenians in Plataiai and Mykale, it came under Greek rule towards the middle of the 5th century BC. In 478 BC, it was accepted into the Delian League by the Athenians. It paid a tax of 15 talents per year to the League.
- Both Byzantium and Kalkhedon were the scene of a war of interests between the Athenians and the Spartans throughout the 5th century BC. In 340/339 BC, Philip II laid siege to Byzantium, but was unable to capture it. From that date until the Roman Imperial Period, there was a period of political stability in the history of Byzantium.

The Roman Empire at its greatest extent



This map illustrates the Roman Empire at its greatest extend and in AD 117. The Emperor Trajan completed the most recent conquests, but many of the new provines (in Mesopotamia, for example) were abandoned after his death and others (as Dacia – Romania) a century later.

Political History of Byzantium (From Its Foundation to 324 AD)

- In the second half of the 3rd century AD, the Goths (Celts) attacked the Byzantine lands.
- In 324, Byzantium was completely captured by the Roman Emperor Constantine I. It became the capital of the Roman Empire in 330.
- Constantine the Great began construction activities in the city to make Byzantium a great and magnificent city again.
  - The name of Byzantium, which was re-established as the new capital of Rome (New Rome) in May 330, was preserved for a while, but was later changed to Constantinople, after the name of the emperor. Constantine the Great intensified public works in the city, adorned it with monuments and made it one of the most magnificent centers of his time..

After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantium (202 B.C. - 330 A.D.): The Period of Septimus Severus

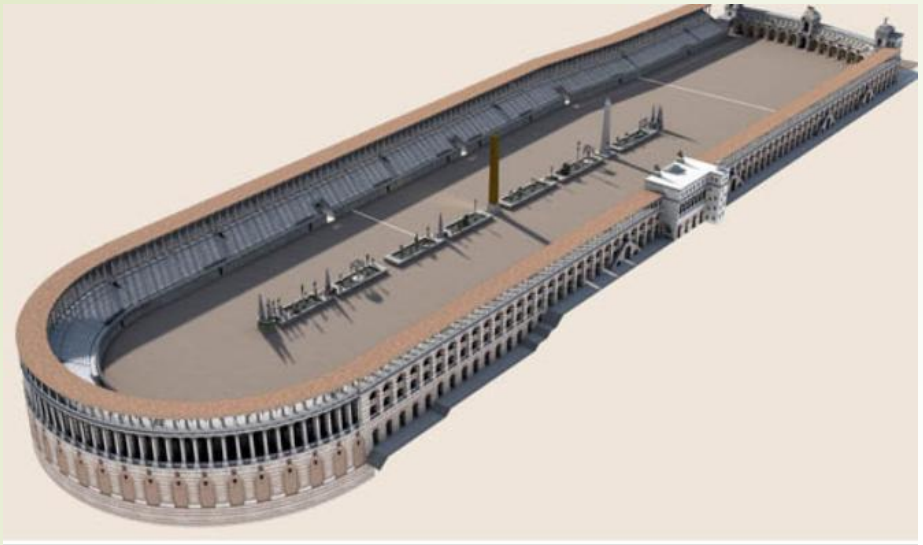
- Upon the attack of the Macedonians, the city of Byzantium asked for help from the Romans (202 BC). When the Romans defeated the Macedonians, they left it independent for a while, but in 146 BC they made it a feudal city affiliated with Rome.
- During the reign of Roman Emperor Vespasiamus, this place was annexed to the province of Bithynia Pontus in 73. Byzantium, which came under Roman rule, sided with the Parthians against the Roman Emperor Septimus Severus in 193. Septimus first massacred the people, destroyed the walls and reduced the city to ruins.
- After a while, Septimus Severus, who felt remorse, rebuilt it upon his son's (Antonius Caracalla) request:
  - The walls were rebuilt on a larger area.
  - New buildings were constructed and streets were opened.
  - The city expanded approximately 33 m on all sides.
  - A square was built in the area where the Topkapi Palace was located, where the people would gather. The stadium where the games would be played was built and the ACROPOLIS was established.
  - In 196, he organized the Hippodrome as a circus. Gladiator fights and chariot races began to be held here. This place became a square where 30,000 people sat as spectators.



1. Aphrodite Temple
2. Apollo Temple
3. Artemis Temple
4. Poseidon Temple
5. Athena Ekbasia Temple
6. Temenos Temple
7. Stadion
8. Amphitheater
9. Demeter Temple
10. Kore Temple
11. Apollo Temple
12. Helios Temple
13. Selene Temple
14. Pluto Temple
15. Hera Temple
16. Agora 1
17. Agora 2
18. Tetrastoon

A reconstruction attempt for the city of Byzantion (reconstruction: a visual or structural re-creation of its past form).

https://byzantium1200.com/byzantion.html









- https://byzantium1200.com/hipodrom.html
  - The illustration depicting the Byzantine hippodrome was prepared by Jonathan Bardill between 2008 and 2010 in connection with the Pera Museum exhibition Hippodrome and Atmeydani: A Stage for Istanbul's History (2010). The resulting computer model is the most detailed reconstruction of a Roman circus to date.

After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C.- AD 330): From the Grenadier of Gallienus to the Roman Capital

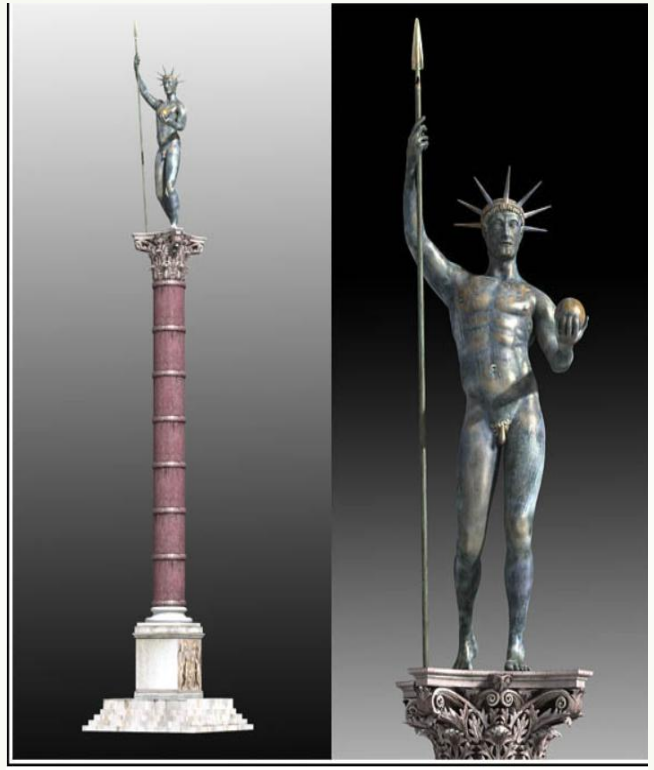
- The city, which rose during the reign of Septimus Severus, was subjected to a new plunder during the reign of Roman Emperor Gallienus. Then the Goths attacked the city.
- After the Roman Emperor Constantine I took back the city in 324, he started a construction activity that would expand the city.
- The city, which was previously limited to Sarayburnu, was enlarged fourfold between 325-330; and designed as a second Roman city.
- Some historical artifacts from Rome, Alexandria, Ephesus, Antioch and Athens were brought to Byzantium to decorate the city. These monuments were erected in the mixed street layout of the city and the squares were determined.
  - **Çemberlitaş (Column of Constantine) , brought from the Temple of Apollo in Rome, was placed in Constantine Square (Forum Constantinus)**
  - https://byzantium1200.com/forum-c.html



The column of Constantine which still stands upright and is known as Çemberlitaş was erected in the center of the square.

After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C.- AD 330): From the Grenadier of Gallienus to the Roman Capital

- **The Forum of Constantine was built at the foundation of Byzantium immediately outside of the old walls.**
- It was circular in shape and had two monumental gates to the east and west.
- **The Column of Constantine** was originally crowned with a statue of Constantine, but this fell down in 1106 and was replaced under Manuel Komnenos (1143-1180) by a cross. Otherwise the forum remained nearly intact until 1204. The Senat House lay on the north side of it. We know from the sources that the square was decorated with a number of antique statues.



This reconstruction shows the Column of Constantine before 1106.
This reconstruction is created for "Jonathan Bardill, Constantine: Divine Emperor of the Christian Golden Age (Cambridge University Press, forthcoming)".



After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C.- AD 330): From the Grenadier of Gallienus to the Roman Capital

- **The Serpent Column, brought from Greece, was erected in the Hippodrome.**
- The Serpent Column is an ancient Greek monument depicting three intertwined python snakes.
- Only a 5-meter section of this bronze column has survived to the present day; the lower and upper parts are broken.
- Two of the snake heads belonging to the Serpent Column are lost; the third head is in the Istanbul Archaeological Museum.







After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C. - 330 A.D.): The capital of Rome

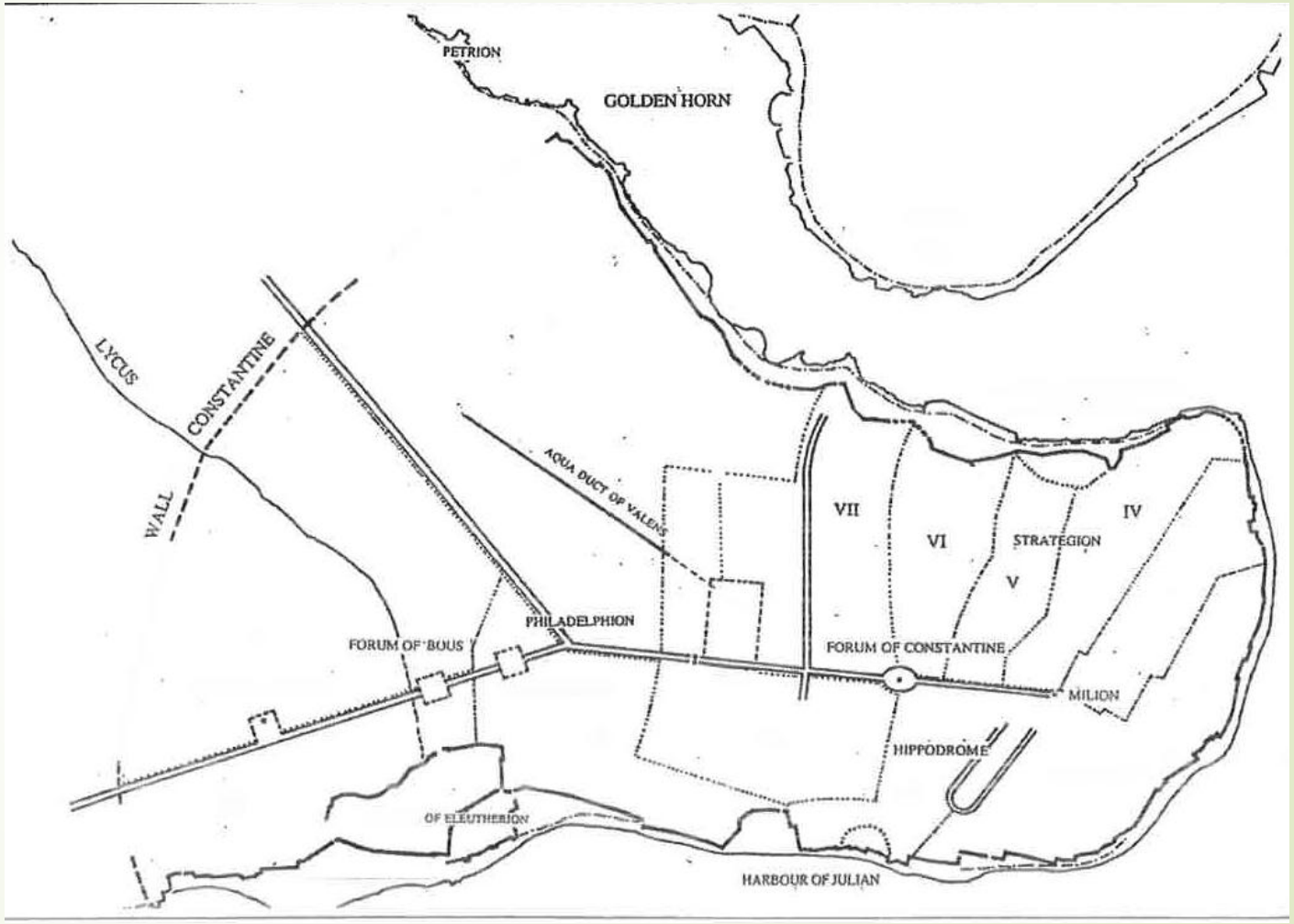
- **The Binbirdirek (Philoxenus) Cistern was built near Divanyolu.**
- Binbirdirek is the second largest underground cistern in Istanbul.
- Cistern of Philoxenos is situated between the Hippodrome of Constantinople and the Forum of Constantine.
- *Cistern: An underground tank, usually made of stone and of various sizes, for the purpose of collecting rainwater and using it when necessary.*



After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C. - 330 A.D.): The capital of Rome

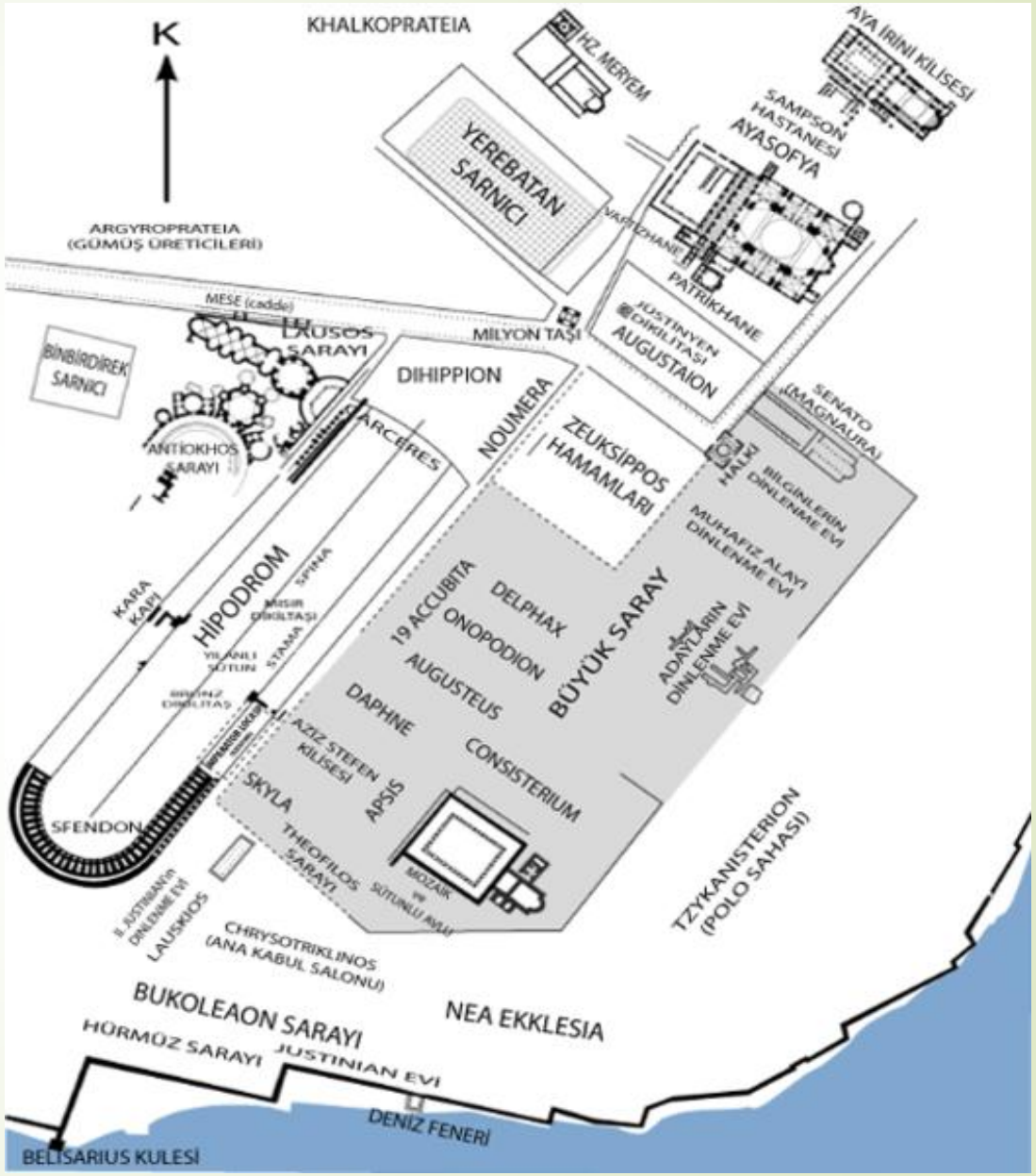
- **The area between the Sea of Marmara and the Golden Horn was surrounded by walls (land walls).**





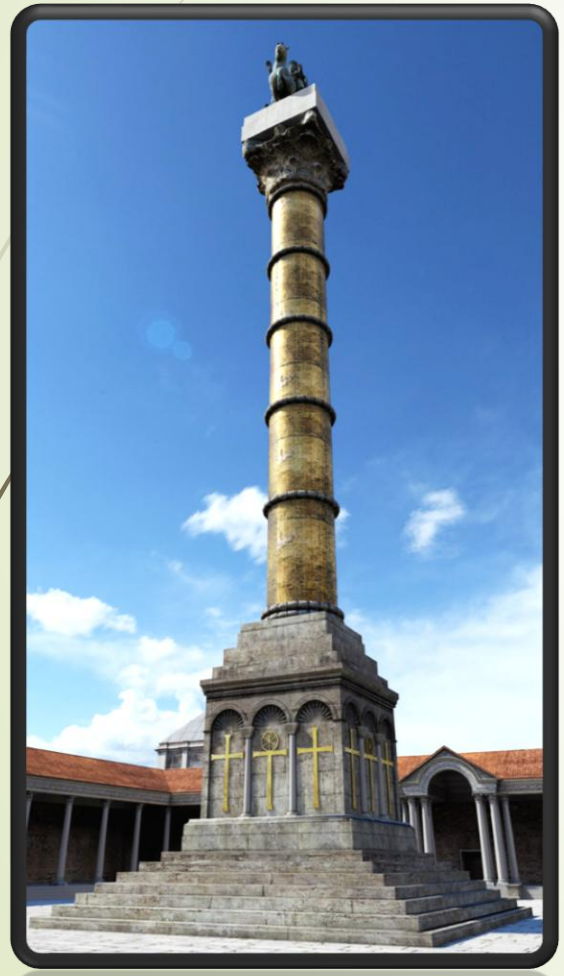
After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C. - 330 A.D.): The capital of Rome

- **Augustaion Square was formed in the park between the Hagia Sophia and Sultanahmet Mosques.**
- The Augustaion was a public square surrounded by colonnades on the south side of the Hagia Sophia.
- It was accessible from the main street, the Mese, that led to the Chalke gate of the Great Palace.
- Although the Hagia Sophia had an atrium on its west side, the Augustaion mostly served as its **forecourt** instead because of its more central position.
- On its western side stood the Column of Justinian. The Augustaion remained intact at least until 1204.
- https://byzantium1200.com/augustaion.html



After the Beginning of the Roman Period in Byzantion (202 B.C. - 330 A.D.): The capital of Rome

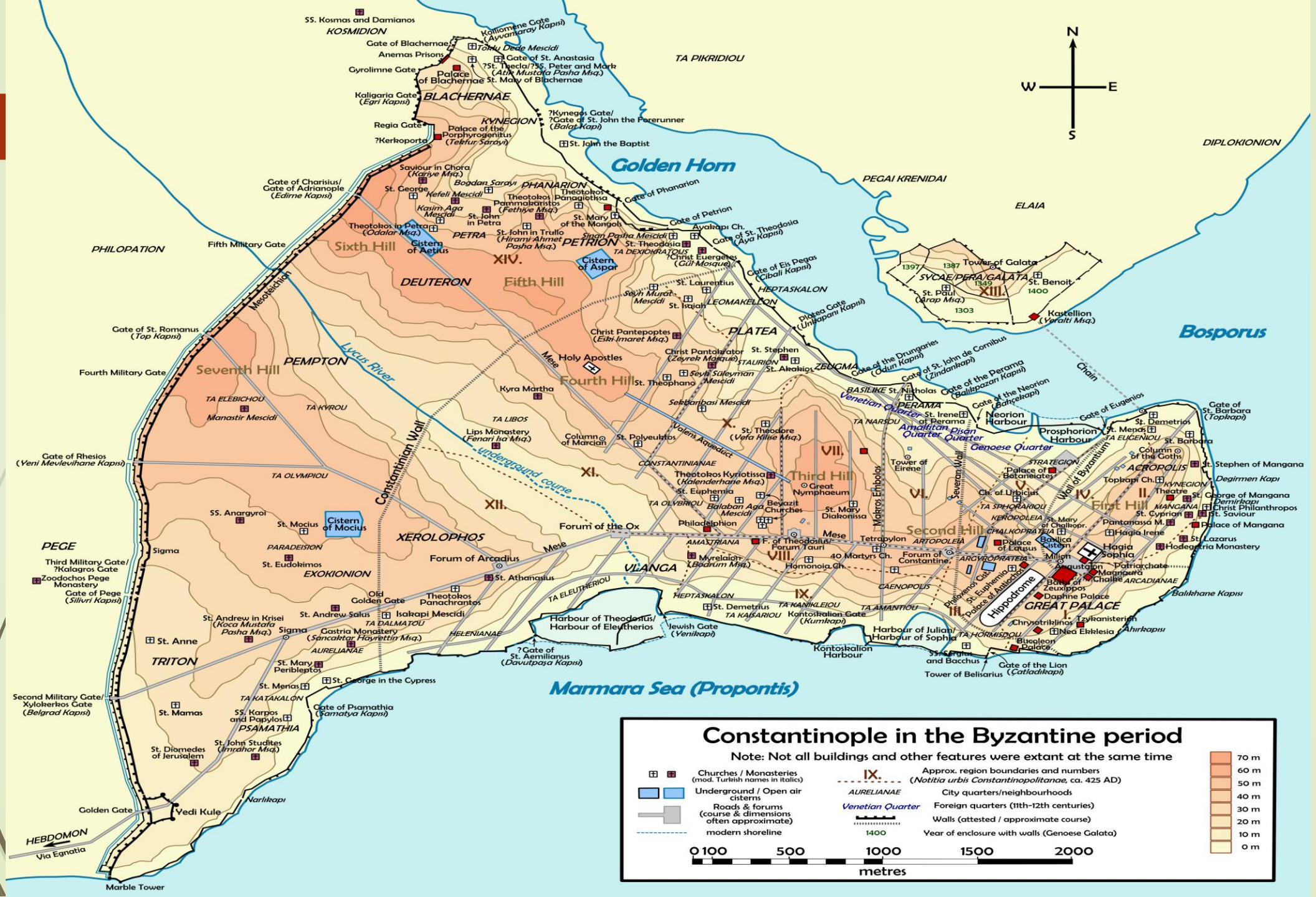
- https://byzantium1200.com/augustaion.html





- On May 11, 330, the opening of the city was celebrated with 40 days of entertainment.
- The capital of the Roman Empire was moved here. It would be called Constantinople following Constantine's name.

- What were Society, agricultural activities, religion, social life in Byzantium?


Constantinople in the Byzantine period
Note: Not all buildings and other features were extant at the same time
Churches / Monasteries (mod. Turkish names in italics)
Underground / Open air cisterns
Roads & forums (course & dimensions often approximate)
modern shoreline
Approx. region boundaries and numbers (Notitia urbis Constantinopolitanae, ca. 425 AD)
City quarters/neighbourhoods
Foreign quarters (11th-12th centuries)
Walls (attested / approximate course)
Year of enclosure with walls (Genoese Galata)
0 100 500 1000 1500 2000
metres
70 m
60 m
50 m
40 m
30 m
20 m
10 m
0 m
Golden Horn
Marmara Sea (Propontis)
Bosporus
Chain
PHILOPATION
PEGE
TRITON
PSAMATHIA
EXOKIONION
XEROLOPHOS
VLANGA
PETRION
PHANARION
KYNEGION
BLACHERNAE
KOSMIDION
DEUTERON
PEMPTON
PETRA
TA PIKRIDIOU
PEGAI KRENIDAI
ELAIA
DIPLOKIONION
SYCAE/PERA/GALATA
PERAMA
ZEUGMA
PLATEA
LEOMAKELLON
HEPTASKALON
STAURION
ACROPOLIS
GREAT PALACE
Hippodrome
Hagia Sophia
Neorion Harbour
Prosphorion Harbour
Kontoskalion Harbour
Harbour of Theodosius/ Harbour of Eleutherios
Harbour of Julian/ Harbour of Sophia
Venetian Quarter
Amalfitan Quarter
Pisan Quarter
Genoese Quarter
Sixth Hill
Fifth Hill
Fourth Hill
Third Hill
Second Hill
First Hill
Seventh Hill
Constantinian Wall
Theodosian Wall
Wall of Byzantium
Severan Wall
Lycus River
underground course
Mese
Forum of the Ox
Forum of Arcadius
Forum of Constantine
Forum Tauri
Milion
Golden Gate
Yedi Kule
Marble Tower
Via Egnatia
HEBDOMON
Narlıkapı
Gate of Charisius/ Gate of Adrianople (Edirne Kapısı)
Fifth Military Gate
Fourth Military Gate
Third Military Gate/ ?Kalagros Gate
Second Military Gate/ Xylokerkos Gate (Belgrad Kapısı)
Gate of St. Romanus (Top Kapısı)
Gate of Rhesios (Yeni Mevlevihane Kapısı)
Gate of Pege (Silivri Kapısı)
Gate of Psamathia (Samatya Kapısı)
Gate of Phanarion
Gate of Petrion
Gate of St. Theodosia (Aya Kapısı)
Gate of Eis Pegas (Cibali Kapısı)
Gate of the Drungaries (Odun Kapısı)
Gate of St. John de Cornibus (Zindankapı)
Gate of the Perama (Balıkpazarı Kapısı)
Gate of the Neorion (Bahçekapı)
Gate of Eugenios
Gate of St. Barbara (Topkapı)
Gate of the Lion (Çatladıkapı)
Gate of St. Aemilianus (Davutpaşa Kapısı)
Gate of St. Anastasia
Gate of Blachernae
Golden Gate
Regia Gate
Kaligaria Gate (Egri Kapısı)
Gyrolimne Gate
Anemas Prisons
Kalliomene Gate (Ayvansaray Kapısı)
Tekfur Sarayı
Palace of Blachernae
Palace of the Porphyrogenitus (Tekfur Sarayı)
Palace of Botaneiates
Palace of Lausus
Palace of Antiochus
Palace of Hormisdas
Daphne Palace
Chrysotriklinos
Boukoleon Palace
Tzykanisterion
Basilica Cistern
Cistern of Aetius
Cistern of Aspar
Cistern of Mocius
Column of Marcian
Column of the Goths
Tower of Eirene
Tower of Belisarius
Tower of Galata
Kastellion (Yeraltı Msq.)
Church of St. Polyeuktos
Church of St. Theodore (Vefa Kilise Msq.)
Church of St. Stephen
Church of St. Akakios
Church of St. Nicholas
Church of St. Irene of Perama
Church of St. Menas
Church of St. Demetrios
Church of St. Barbara
Church of St. Stephen of Mangana
Church of St. George of Mangana
Church of St. Saviour
Church of St. Lazarus
Church of St. Mary Diakonissa
Church of St. Mary of Chalkoprateia
Church of St. Mary of the Mongols
Church of St. Mary Periblepstos
Church of St. Mary of Blachernae
Church of St. Mary of Pharos
Church of St. Mary of Chalkoprateia
Church of St. Mary of Chalkoprateia
Church of St. Mary of Chalkoprateia

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0K9suVewMYo



A view of Constantinople (reconstruction drawing attempt)

AGRICULTURE, FISHING AND LIVESTOCK IN BYZANTIUM

- Fishing was a very important source of income in Istanbul in ancient times as well. The bonitos that migrated from the Black Sea to the Aegean Sea through the Bosphorus every year had almost become the symbol of the city. In particular, the Golden Horn was teeming with bonito.
- It is understood from the fish and fishing equipment depictions on the coins minted in the city that fishing was very important for Byzantium.
- Strabon also mentions the abundance of bonitos in the Bosphorus while explaining that the current carried bonitos from the shores of Chalcedon to the direction of Byzantium; he even says that bonitos were so abundant in the Golden Horn that they could be caught by hand.
- Sometimes two bonito fish side by side and sometimes a dolphin between two bonito fish are depicted on Byzantium's Roman Empire coins.

- Since the lands of Byzantium were fertile, good and quality products were obtained. However, the Byzantines were not able to plant in safety because they were afraid that their fields would be plundered by the Thracians.
- The cattle (sığır) on the first silver coins of Byzantion are also evidence that the city raised cattle. In addition, Demeter, the Goddess of Agriculture and Fertility, is depicted with a horn of abundance in her hand on Hellenistic coins.



Coins of the city of Byzantium, V-IV centuries (Istanbul Archaeological Museum, Coins Section)

SOCIAL LAYERS AND SETTLEMENT IN BYZANTIUM

- The settlement area of the city, which was called “Byzantion” until the 3rd century, is on the hill called Sarayburnu today, at the entrance of the “Golden Horn” and in the southwest direction of the Bosphorus, which separates or connects Europe and Asia.
- Being at an important point of trade between the Black Sea and the Aegean, Byzantium’s identity as a commercial city has been highlighted.
- It is stated in various sources that the city’s top administrators chose to settle in the area known today as “Sirkeci” behind the port, and that the necropolis (cemetery) defining the city’s border is the area known today as Çemberlitaş.
- In terms of the spatial reflection of the city and its external power, the acropolis, as in all ancient Greek settlements, is on the dominant hill of the city and defines the focal point of the city with various temples, baths, theaters, and agora.
- Byzantium, which hosted many foreign sailors and merchants in its ports and agoras at the mouth of the Golden Horn as a trading city during the ancient Greek and Roman periods, was connected to Rome with the arrival of Roman imperialism in Anatolia, and thus came into contact with Roman culture and the Romans who came to the city.

SOCIAL LAYERS AND SETTLEMENT IN BYZANTIUM

- Byzantium, which could not recover from the destruction of Roman Emperor Septimius Severus, was equipped with structures specific to Roman culture such as gymnasium, hippodrome, aqueduct, theater, colonnaded streets, etc. upon the request of his son Caracalla. **All of these can be seen as signs of the transition from an Ancient Greek city to a Roman city.**
- Roman administrators and wealthy merchants who settled in the city and the Byzantines who acquired Roman citizenship after 212 began to be seen as a class belonging to the upper class from this period onwards.
- After becoming the capital of the Eastern Roman Empire, the people living in the city exhibited a colorful social diversity with the addition of new social classes to the ones that had existed since the beginning.

ADMINISTRATIVE AND SOCIAL STRUCTURE IN BYZANTIUM

- The highest state official in Byzantium was the “hieromnamon”.
- Byzantium had a council whose members were called “pentekaideka” (fifteen).
- It is known that the people of Byzantium were classified in groups of one hundred called hekatostys.
- In addition to fully legal citizens, foreigners with special status called “metoikoi” also lived in Byzantium.
- Foreigners with special status residing in the city could not own land. During times of economic crisis, the Byzantines would rent out the land cultivated on state lands for a certain period of time and the vacant lands indefinitely.
- The clergy whose properties were confiscated were given the gymnasium, agora and other public lands belonging to the state around the port.

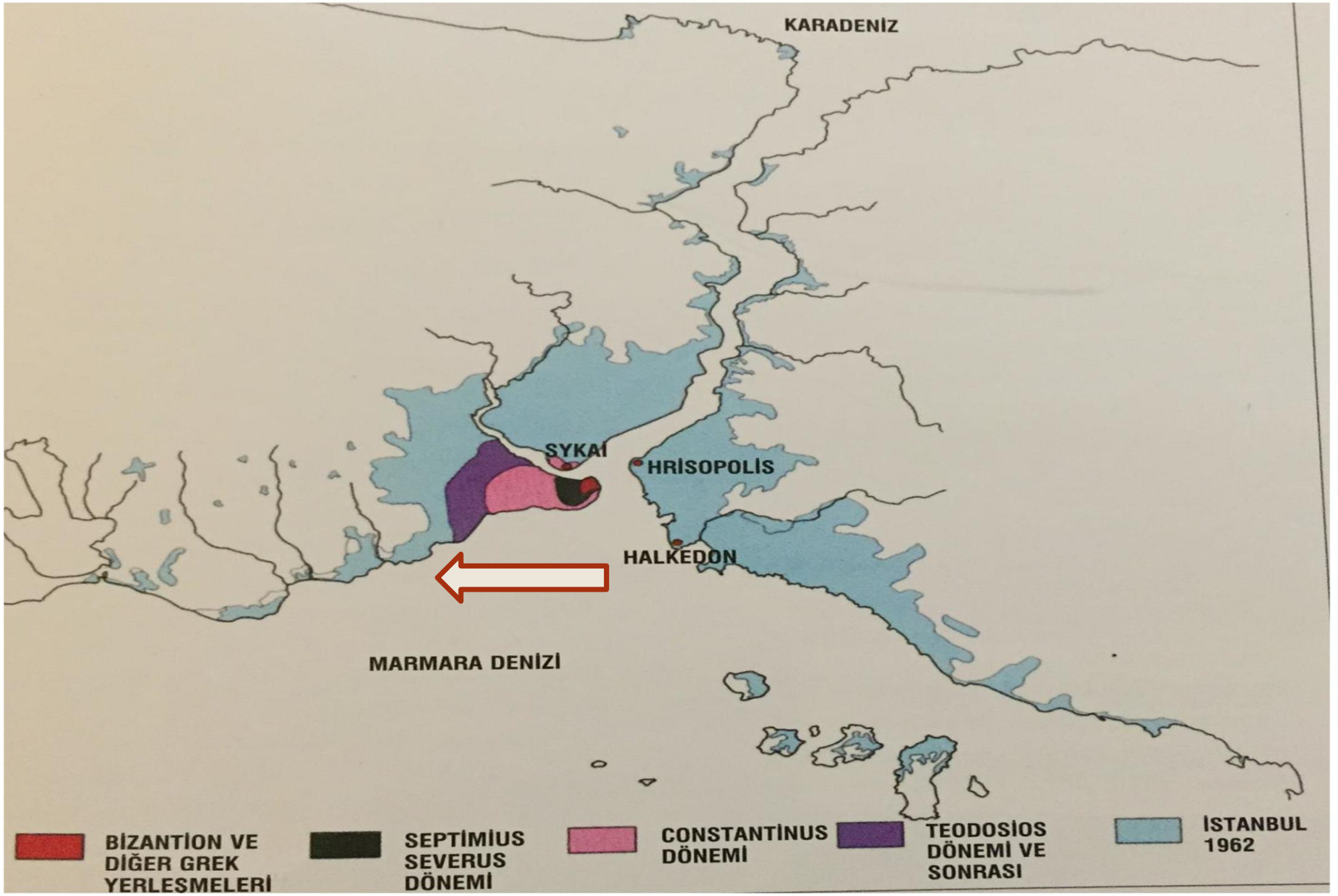
SOCIAL STRUCTURE

- Some professional groups in Byzantium, such as fishermen, salt merchants, jugglers, mediums, magicians, etc., paid one-third of their earnings as taxes.
- The names of an astronomer, a midwife, a female doctor named Mousa, an educator (paidagog) named Athenodoros, and judges named Apollonnides (from Miletus) and Iatrokles (from Mylas) who served in Byzantium are mentioned in the tombstones found in Istanbul and its vicinity.
- The tombstone belonging to an educator is currently located in the Museum of Natural History at the Smithsonian Institute in Washington, DC. The tombstone in question was found during an excavation in Taksim in 1912. The tombstone, which dates back to the 2nd century BC, features a short-bearded male figure sitting on a stool (diphros) and the inscription “Paidagog (educator) Athenodoros, farewell.” above it. The word paidagogue on the tombstone here actually refers to a person who worked as a kind of house slave and whose job was to take children to school and help them with their homework and education.

RELIGION IN BYZANTION: PAGANISM

- **According to a story told by the historian Herodotus, the religious culture of ancient Byzantium, founded by a group of Megarian colonists, naturally took shape within the framework of ancient Greek paganism.**
- Byzas, the leader of the colonists who founded Byzantium, established the cult of Rhea as the goddess of fate (Tykhe) of this new settlement. As in other cities of the Greek-Roman world, pagan religious ceremonies in Byzantium were social activities that included offerings (libations or offering of first products) and sacrifices in order to maintain paxdeorum (peace of the gods). Because ancient paganism was not a theological religion that produced solutions to the spiritual problems of individuals, but rather consisted of a series of public activities. Because in the pagan world, philosophers, not clergy, were interested in deep questions such as the "origin of the universe" or the "meaning of life".

  The main purpose of religious public activities in which the public participated was to calm the anger of the gods and ensure social peace.
- As a public religion, paganism was under the direct rule of a city-state, but it had no theology, sacred text, or professional clergy. Religious ceremonies in the city were overseen by the city's rulers.



Please notice how the city expanded toward the landward side!